



1ST ATLAS GLOBAL ACADEMIC CONFERENCE 2025

27 – 28 August

**Bridging academia, industry and commerce for inclusive
growth**

Venue: Elephant Hills, Victoria Falls

Day 1: Wednesday 27 August 2025 Venue: Elephant Hills, Victoria Falls

TIME	ACTIVITY	FACILITATOR
08.00-08.15	Arrival and registration	Secretariat
08.15-08.30	Welcome Remarks to the 1 st Edition of the 2025 Atlas Global Academic Conference by Prof Ephias Ruhode	Teurai Matekenya
08.30-08.45	Keynote Address: Prof. Rukuni. [Board Chair Zimbabwe Council of Higher Education]	Ephias Ruhode
	PAPER PRESENTATIONS:	PRESENTER/AUTHORS
	Theme: Regional and Transnational innovations in Agriculture and Food security: Session Chair : Dr Fungai Nora Mukora	
08.45-09.00	Navigating the effects of load shedding on agricultural productivity and food security: A case study of South Africa,	Prof Ngoepe-Ntsoane
09.00-09.15	When Less Becomes More: Frugal Innovation in Micro-Farming for Climate-Resilient and Food Systems in Northern Nigeria	Inyene Nkata; Abdulrasaq Ajadi Ishola; Tokunbo Alaga Olorundami
09.15-09.30	Strengthening Farmer's Adaptation to Climate Change Impacts on Pest Management, Weather Forecasting and Crop Planning: How Appropriate are Digital Tools?	Prof Ngoepe-Ntsoane, Sifiso Fana Mdluli; Nonkululeko Ndaba; Funeka Manzi
09.30-10.00	Health Break	
	Theme: Growing the rural economy and rural industrialization : Session Chair: Prof Nobert Jere	
10.00-10.15	Transforming Agrotourism in Africa: Harnessing Digital and Social Media Marketing Strategies for Overcoming Business Challenges Among Zimbabwean Entrepreneurs	Dr. Theo Tsokota, Doreen Nkala; Chipso Mutongi
10.15-10.30	Innovative Agro-Processing Technologies as Catalysts for Rural Industrialization and Economic Growth. "A case study for Marange in Mutare.	Juliet Mupete; Kupara Sencilia
10.30-10.45	Colonialism's enduring legacy: Unpacking the Roots of rural underdevelopment, curving a path for growing the rural economy in Zimbabwe-The case of Nembudziya Gokwe North	Dr Tapiwa Musasa
10.45-11.00	The impact of rural industrialisation on community health and well-being in Zimbabwe.	Plaxedes Makoni; Dr Njabulo Nkomazana
11.00-11.15	Sustainable financing rural economic development in southern African countries. A systematic review	Dr Shadreck Nhorito; Prof Collins C Ngwake
11.15-11.30	Growing rural economies leveraging beekeeping: Income implications of beekeeping value chain integration.	Prof Taruvinga, O Zamisa
11.30-11.45	Health Break	
	Theme: Societal implications of technology, smart cities and smart villages in Africa: Session Chair: Christinah Moyo	

11.45-12.00	The Role of Entrepreneurs in Advancing Smart Cities and Smart Villages in Zimbabwe: Societal Implications of Technology	Doreen Nkala, Chipo Mutongi; Theo Tsokota
12.00-12.15	Societal Implications of Technology, Smart Cities, and Smart Villages in Africa	Dr Nontethelelo Tshivhase; Dr Sanderson Abel
12.15-12.30	Zimbabwe through the lenses of Three African content creators	
	Theme: Technology enabled healthcare (mHealth/eHealth, public health and wellbeing in Africa. Session Chair: Venaan Karina Paulus	
12.30-12.45	Explainable Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare: Applicability in African Communities	Jere Nobert
12.45-1.00	An Improved Linac Mechanical Quality Assurance Device (The LINATHAD) and its Implications in The Medical Field.	Prince Chitopho
1.00-2.00	Lunch break	
	Theme: Future of work: skills, education, employment and small business development in Africa. Session Chair: Prof A Taruvinga	
2.00-2.15	The Future of Work: Navigating the intersection of automation, Remote Work, and Human-Centred Skills in the digital revolution	Herbert Masukume
2.15-2.30	Skills, Education, Employment, and Sustainability in Renewable Energy SMEs: A Namibia-Zimbabwe Cross-Country Comparison	Marcus Mutanga; Venaan Paulus; Enard Mutenheri, Mbela Kalengay
2.30-2.45	The efficacy of technical vocational education and training programs in aligning graduate skills with the demands of Africa's emerging green economy: A literature review.	Wilson Mabhandla
2.45-3.00	The Role of Intellectual Property in Driving the Operationalization of Education 5.0 in TVET Institutions: The Case of Kwekwe Polytechnic, Zimbabwe	Sylvia Tendai Moto; P. Muredzi
3.00-3.15	Technology's Impact on Innovation in Education 5.0: Navigating Challenges of Intellectual Property in a Digital Age – Case of Kwekwe Polytechnic, Zimbabwe	Sylvia Tendai Moto; Margret Simango
3.15–3.30	Health Break	
3.30-3.45	The contribution of digital skills and knowledge to university students' inclination to embark on the fashion and beauty digital entrepreneurial start-ups in South Africa: a scoping review	Maphanga; Smangele Pretty Moyane; Ntando Nkomo; Collence Takaingehamo Chisita
3.45-4.00	Entrepreneurship as a Catalyst for Employment: Fostering Small Business Growth in South Africa.	Bongumusa Ngcobo; Mbalenhle Khumalo
4.00-4.15	Exploring the Role of Artificial Intelligence in Empowering Women-runner Entrepreneurs	Ruth Tafadzwa Nyamadzawo
4.15-4.30	Unpacking Policy Theory and Practice: Evaluating Service Provision and Uptake in Higher Education in Zimbabwe	Fungai Nora Mukora; Chadzimura CC; Kagondo BVT; and Nherera CM

4.30-4.45	Entrepreneurial creativity and small firm internationalisation: A theoretical nexus.	Benjamin Byarugaba
4.45–5.00	Bridging Borders, Building Futures: The Role of International Education in Shaping Africa's Workforce and Entrepreneurial Ecosystem	Agnes Nsor
END OF DAY I		

Day 2 Thursday 28 August 2025 Venue: Elephant Hills, Victoria Falls

TIME	ACTIVITY	FACILITATOR
08.15-08.30	Keynote Presentation: Dr King Omeihe, University of the West of Scotland	Ephias Ruhode
	PAPER PRESENTATIONS:	PRESENTER
	Theme: Public private partnerships: driving economic growth through collaboration : Session Chair Slyvia Tendai Moto	
08.30-08.45	Fostering manufacturing entrepreneurship through polytechnic-industry collaborations: A pathway to economic growth in Zimbabwe	Christinah Moyo; Theresa Mberikwazvo
08.45-09.00	Public-Private Partnership and Indigenous Knowledge Production for African Development	Bamigbose
	Theme: Fintech and Financial inclusion in Africa; Session Chair: Margret Simango	
9.00-9.15	Framework for Cryptocurrency Adoption as a Digital Currency by Zimbabwean Companies	T. Tsokota; S. Mandizvidza; C T Chifumbu; Kangare; C Mutongi
9.15-9.30	Impact of Bank-Fintech Collaboration on Financial Inclusion in Sub Saharan Africa.	Manford Moyo; T M Mango
9.30-9.45	Business Intelligence Framework on electronic banking in Zimbabwe Financial Service Sector.	Effort Mtombeni
9.55-10.00	Financial Inclusion of Rural Young Women In Zimbabwe: A Case of Saving Clubs in Ward 2 in Chiredzi.	S C Matema; T Chiparausha; G Musvipa
10.00-10.30	Health Break	
	Theme: Sustainable development and inclusive digital transformation : Session Chair: Manford Moyo	
10.30-10.45	Challenges-faced-in-implementation-of-green-procurement	Melisa Ncube; C Sinchansambwe; Sultan Al Kaabi SQ
10.45-11.00	Leveraging Digital Marketing for Inclusive Growth: Sustainable Strategies to Bridge the Digital Divide in Zimbabwe.	Rukudzo Alison Mawere
11.00-11.15	Sustainable development and Inclusive Digital Transformation	P Marandure; Nyasha Zibwowa

11.15-11.30	Inclusive Digital Transformation for Sustainable Development to Bridge the Digital Divide in Sub-Saharan Africa: A Case Study in Zimbabwe	R Chigariro; Dr S Musungwini
11.30-11.45	Overcoming Obstacles and Maximizing Opportunities for AI-Driven Research in Zimbabwe's Indigenous Languages: Pathways to Innovation and Inclusive Sustainable Economic Growth	Dr M Mazuruse; N Nhemachena
11.45-12.00	Technoethics and Heuristic Reasoning: Ethical Heuristics for Advanced Technology Adoption in South African Digital Transformation Initiatives	Amanda Vester
12.00-12.15	The US-SA Media briefing as a theatre of global diplomacy in the digital era	Witness Roya
12.15-12.30	Sanctions, Protectionism, and Food: Assessing the Consequences for African Agricultural Trade and Food & Nutritional Security	Shandini Naidoo
	Theme: Regional Transnational and Global Trade and Investment for industrialization of Africa : Session Chair Agnes Nsor	
12.30-12.45	Assessing the attractiveness of African countries to Chinese Foreign Direct Investment using non-parametric approaches	Abson Chompolola.
	Theme: Digital inclusion through modernization of government services: Session Chair: Shandini Naidoo	
12.45-1.00	Bridging the digital divide: An assessment of e-learning accessibility and impact on skill development for rural youth in Zimbabwe's secondary education sector	Wilson Mabhandu
	Theme: Corporate Governance and Social Responsibility	
1.00 -1.15	Strengthening community partnership for conservation: Gonarezhou Conservation Trust's engagement with Shangani people in Chiredzi, Zimbabwe	Lister Matsilele
1.15 - 2.15	Lunch break	
2.15 -	Departure for Excursion	
END OF DAY 2		